

TaskMentor — Local Setup

NGA TaskMentor · run it on your own laptop · about 20 minutes

TaskMentor is a React app (`client/`, `http://localhost:5174`) and an Express API (`server/`, `http://localhost:5002`) on a MySQL database. You sign in with your NGA MIS account — the app has no login of its own. A third part, `live-server/` (:5003), is only needed for the proctoring module.

Before you start

Install **Node.js 20 or newer**, **Git**, and **MySQL 8** (nodejs.org · git-scm.com · dev.mysql.com/downloads/installer — choose “Server only”), and get two things from your team lead:

Your NGA MIS login	the same account you use at mis.amashuri.com
The TaskMentor client secret	one shared value for the team — goes into <code>SSO_CLIENT_SECRET</code> in step 3

1 · Get the code

```
git clone https://github.com/niyongaboemmy/nga-task-mentor.git
cd nga-task-mentor
npm install
npm install --prefix server
npm install --prefix client
```

2 · Create your settings files

```
Copy-Item server\.env.example server\.env
Copy-Item client\.env.example client\.env
```

On macOS or Linux use `cp server/.env.example server/.env` and the same for `client`.

3 · Fill in `server/.env`

Open `server/.env` and change these two lines. Leave everything else as it is; `client/.env` needs no changes.

Setting	Value
<code>DB_PASS</code>	your MySQL root password (leave empty if you set none)
<code>SSO_CLIENT_SECRET</code>	the client secret from your team lead

4 · Create the database

```
mysql -u root -p -e "CREATE DATABASE taskmentor_dev CHARACTER SET utf8mb4 COLLATE utf8mb4_unicode_ci;"
mysql -u root -p taskmentor_dev < server\taskmentor_dev.sql
```

`mysql` lives in MySQL's `bin` folder (Windows: `C:\Program Files\MySQL\MySQL Server 8.0\bin`), or use MySQL Workbench → Server → Data Import. The second line loads sample quizzes; skip it and you start empty.

5 · Run it

```
npm run dev
```

Server and client start together and reload as you edit. Open **http://localhost:5174**, click **Sign in**, log in on the MIS page, and you are sent back signed in. For proctoring also run `npm run live-server` (copy `live-server/.env.example` to `.env` first). Stop with Ctrl+C.

6 · Working on a feature

Pushing to main deploys to production. Always work on a branch and open a Pull Request:

```
git checkout -b feature/short-description
# make and test your changes, then
git push -u origin feature/short-description
```

If something goes wrong

You see	Do this
<i>Access denied / ECONNREFUSED :3306</i>	Wrong DB_PASS, or MySQL is not running (start the “MySQL80” service).
<i>Failed to authorize application</i>	Tell your team lead — the MIS needs <code>http://localhost:5174/sso/callback</code> on its allowed list for TaskMentor. One-time fix on their side.
<i>Failed to exchange SSO code</i>	SSO_CLIENT_SECRET in <code>server/.env</code> is wrong. Fix it and restart.
<i>Port 5174 is already in use</i>	Stop the other process (<code>netstat -ano findstr :5174</code>) and start again.
<i>Unknown column ... after pulling new code</i>	A teammate added a migration: <code>npm run migrate</code> in <code>server/</code> .
Want a clean database	Drop and recreate <code>taskmentor_dev</code> , then import the snapshot again (step 4).

Checks: `curl http://localhost:5002/health` · `npm test` in `server/` · `npm run lint` in `client/`